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C3 Teaching and Learning K-8 Framework – Sample Scope and Sequence

Kindergarten – Me and My Community

The focus of kindergarten is to provide students with opportunities to explore topics that affect them and their personal environments. These include basic citizenship skills such as rule making and compliance, and how these change in different settings (school, home, community). Students will engage in learning about themselves, their schools, their cities/towns, and local communities. They will also develop an awareness of the similarities and differences among individuals in the classroom as well as within the school and community. Students will have the opportunity to compare how life in the past is different from today, with respect to their own experiences within their home, classroom, and community.

Grade 1 – People, Places, and the Environment

In grade 1, students will learn how they are connected to the world around them and develop a deeper understanding of how diverse cultures, values, and beliefs help to shape the world in which we live. Students will further develop a sense of purpose and empathy regarding their role and the role of other citizens within the community and world. As a global citizen, it is developmentally appropriate for students to identify similarities and differences from others (cultural, likes and dislikes, gender, skin color, hair, and eye color). Best practice is having materials and visuals that are representative of people, cultures, and the community in which they live. They will have the opportunity to look for ways that they can be civic-minded and make change happen within their own classroom, school, and community. Students will develop an understanding of how basic economic concepts influence people, places, and the environment. They will learn that people not only use the environment to meet their needs and wants but also that the environment often dictates where and how people choose to live. Students will continue building on group skills, including roles, rules, voicing an opinion, and conflict resolution skills with adult support. They will enhance their knowledge of spatial awareness of their surroundings by furthering the use of geographic representations, tools, and terminology to process information about the world around them. Students will continue to compare life in the past to life today as they study the contributions of historical figures and how those figures have helped shape and change various communities and environments across the globe.

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2nd Grade – The Americas

In grade 2, students will expand on their understanding of the concept of community by exploring past and present neighboring communities in Central America, North America, South America, and the Caribbean. Students will explain continuities and differences among cultures, governments, traditions, and available resources to investigate how individuals work together while acknowledging different perspectives and cultivating empathy. Students will learn how culture spreads across borders and compare and contrast Vermont/local community governments, customs, and traditions to others in the Americas. Students will explain current and historic patterns of human settlement and compare the ways various cultural groups connect and interact across the Americas. Students will describe how resources vary across geography and climates and discuss how resources can be categorized as renewable and non-renewable.

3rd Grade – Global Interactions

In grade 3, students will expand on their understanding of the concept of community and widen their global lens by exploring interactions between groups of people in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania. Students will explain continuities and differences among cultures, governments, traditions, and resources to investigate how individuals work together while acknowledging different perspectives and cultivating empathy. Students will learn how culture spreads across borders and compare and contrast Vermont/local community customs and traditions to others in the world. Students will explain current and historic patterns of human settlement and compare the ways various cultural groups connect and interact. Students will describe how resources vary across geography and climates and discuss how resources can be categorized as renewable and non-renewable.

4th Grade – Vermont, the Early Republic, and the United States.: Pre-Colonial Times to the Civil War

In grade 4, students will examine change and continuity in Vermont and United States history from pre-colonial times to the Civil War. Students will understand the concept of movement and its impact on people, goods, and ideas; learn how natural resources have influenced economic development; and examine the conflicts and compromises that resulted from migration and settlement. This learning will allow students to understand the tensions and factors that led to the fight for independence, the establishment of the United States, and subsequent Vermont statehood. Students will prepare for their role as responsible and informed citizens by examining the Vermont Constitution and the U.S. Constitution, including the determinants of power and its effects; exploring the development, structure, and function of the United States

government as well as the role of individual rights and responsibilities; examining the choices made by various groups of people on the development of the United States through the Civil War; and learning how events, people, and ideas shaped and influenced our democratic system. Grade 4 provides the framework for further study of Vermont and U.S. History in grade 7, civics in grade 8, and U.S. History/American Government in high school.

5th Grade – World Geography and Ancient Civilizations I: Western Asia, the Middle East, North Africa, Sub-Saharan Africa

In grade 5, students will explore how people moved, traded, and interacted with others in early civilizations. They will learn how geography, power, wealth, and religion shaped the growth and culture of these societies. Students will focus on regions like Western Asia, the Middle East, North Africa, and Sub-Saharan Africa. They will also learn about important cultural contributions and lasting achievements. By studying ancient history, students will better understand the roots of the modern world.

6th Grade – World Geography and Ancient Civilization II: South and East Asia, Oceania, Latin America, and Europe

In grade 6, students will examine how movement and migration impacted the interactions between expanding civilizations through conquest and trade, including the physical and political geography and ancient societies of South and East Asia, Oceania, Latin America, and Europe. Students will note how geography, power, wealth and religion influence culture, change, and development within civilizations as they examine how the perspectives of political science, economics, geography, history, and archaeology apply to the study of regions and countries. Students will develop an appreciation of cultural contributions (art, music, literature, architecture) and lasting achievements in science and technology. Grade 6 concludes with a study of government in Greece and Rome, which serves as a prelude to the study of civics in grade 8. Through an understanding of ancient history, students will develop an appreciation for the foundations of the modern world.

7th Grade – Vermont and the U.S.: Reconstruction to the Modern Civil Rights Movement

In grade 7, students will build on their knowledge of Vermont and United States politics, geography, economics, and peoples as they re-visit the sectional conflicts over slavery

that continued into Reconstruction and beyond and led to the long struggle in the 19th and 20th centuries for civil rights. Grade 7 content spans decades; takes students through Reconstruction, industrialization, and world wars, and allows students to dig into critical topics and America's role in them, such as human rights, the Holocaust, genocide, women's suffrage, and atomic weaponry. By the end of grade 7, students will have a broad understanding of the roles that politics and power have played both locally and on a world stage; be aware of their changing cultural and physical environments; and gain keen insight as to the ways in which individuals, businesses, governments, and societies make decisions. This broad journey provides a framework for understanding and will allow for deeper analysis of history in high school.

8th Grade – Civics and Economics in Action

In grade 8, students will utilize past knowledge and understanding to expand their focus on the core concepts and principles underlying America's democracy; the structure and limits of the national government as set forth in the United States Constitution, including an examination of democratic ideals; and the role of the citizen in a democratic society. Students will collaborate to identify a problem(s); develop solutions that would require government involvement; and participate in student-led civics projects focused on developing civic knowledge, skills, dispositions, and media literacy. Students will also learn about the workings of both national and global economies and develop an understanding of the decision-making processes of individuals, businesses, and governments and how they are connected. Gaining an understanding of economic resources, such as human capital, land, technology, and investments, and how they play a role in big-picture decision making in a global environment will assist students in making informed decisions in a wide variety of contexts.

Note: This class is not seen as a replacement for higher-level analysis of civic and personal finance concepts at the high school level, but rather as a foundation for deeper learning in financial literacy and civics/American Government.